

TOEFL IBT Listening Placement Test – Answer Keys

Listening 1

1	B
2	D
3	C
4	B
5	D
6	C

Listening 2

7	C
8	A
9	B
10	B
11	B
12	B

Listening 3

13	C
14	B
15	C
16	C
17	C
18	C

Listening 4

19	B
20	A, C
21	A
22	D
23	A

Listening 5

24	B
25	D
26	D
27	C
28	C

Audio scripts

Placement Test

The listening section tests your ability to understand spoken English that is typical of interactions and academic speech on college campuses. During the test, you will respond to conversations and lectures. After each listening passage, you will answer five to six questions about it. You will hear each conversation or lecture one time. You may take notes while you listen, but notes are not graded. You may use your notes to answer the questions.

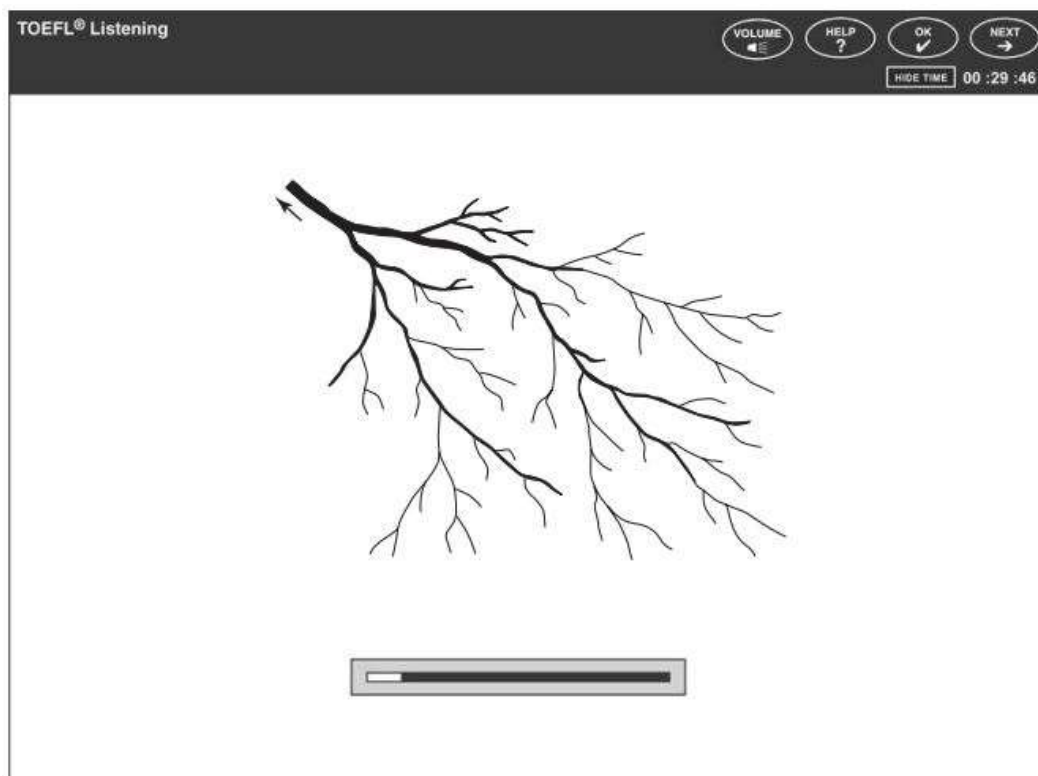
Listening 1 “Geology Class”

Listen to part of a lecture in a geology class.

Professor:

Okay, today we're going to discuss the four major types of drainage patterns. I trust you've already read the chapter, so you'll recall that a drainage pattern is the arrangement of channels that carry water in an area. And these patterns can be very distinctive, since they're determined by the climate, the topography, and the composition of the rock that underlies the formations. So, consequently, we can see that a drainage pattern is really a good visual summary of the characteristics of a particular region, both geologically and climatically. In other words, when we look at drainage patterns, we can draw conclusions about the structural formation and relief of the land as well as the climate.

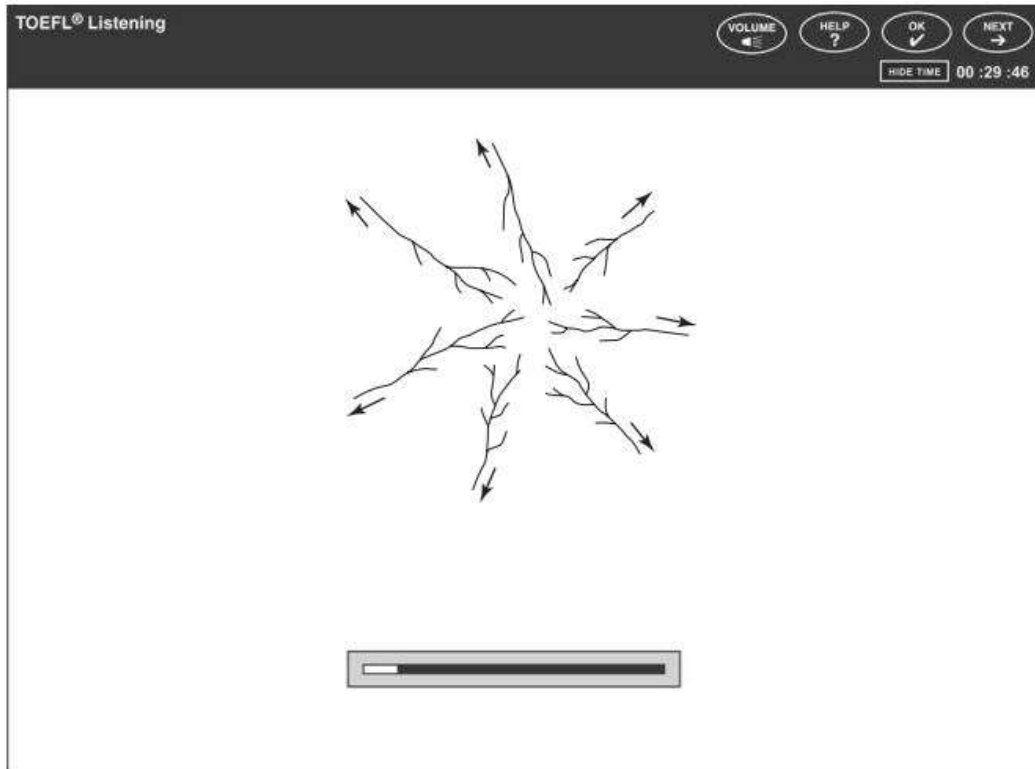
Now, all drainage systems are composed of an interconnected network of streams, and when we view them together, they form distinctive patterns. Although there are at least seven identifiable kinds of drainage patterns, for our purposes, we're going to limit our study to the four major types. Probably the most familiar pattern is the dendritic drainage pattern.



This is a stream that looks like the branches of a tree. Here's an example of a dendritic pattern. As you can see, it's similar to many systems in nature. In addition to the structure of a tree, it also resembles the human circulation system. This is a very efficient drainage system because the overall length of any one

branch is fairly short, and there are many branches. So, that allows the water to flow quickly and efficiently from the source or sources.

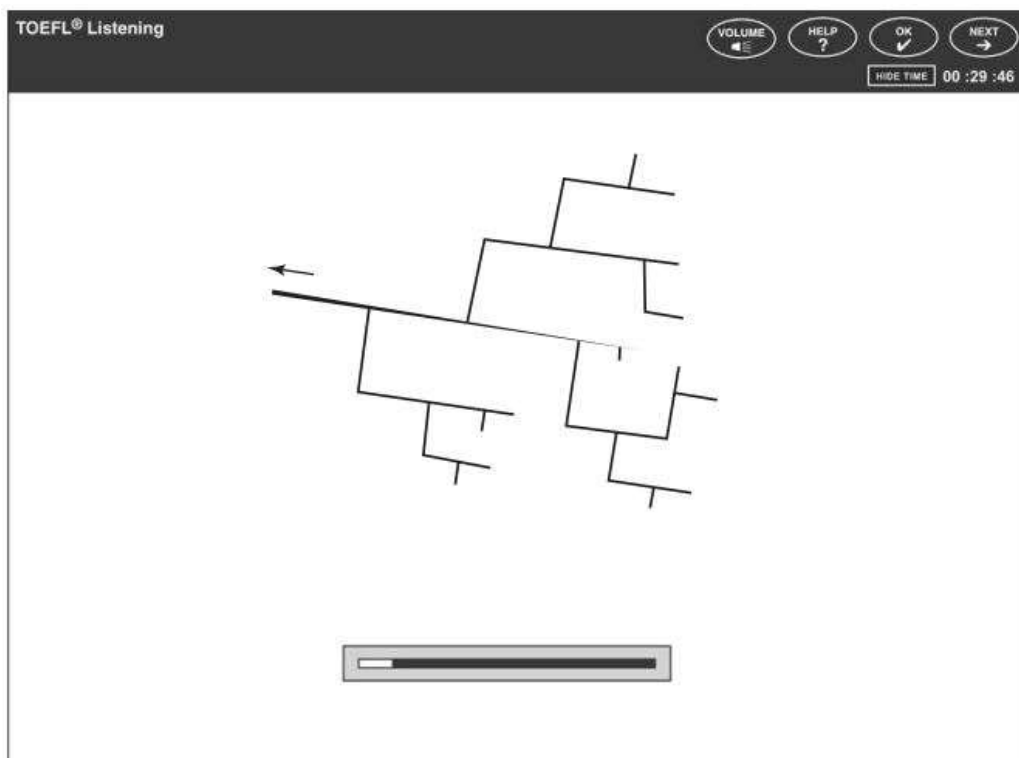
Okay, let's look at the next example.



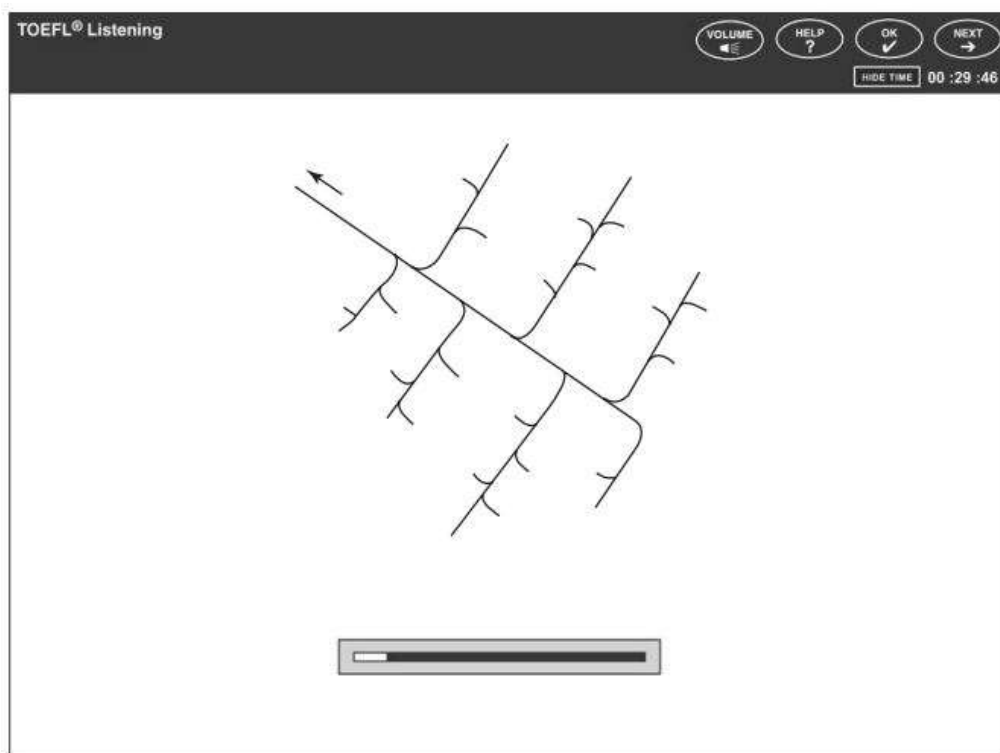
This drainage pattern is referred to as a radial pattern. Notice how the streams flow from a central point. This is usually a high mountain or a volcano. It kind of looks like the spokes that radiate out from the hub of a wheel. When we see a radial pattern, we know that the areas experienced uplift and that the direction of the drainage is down the slopes of a relatively isolated central point.

Going back to the dendritic for a moment, the pattern is determined by the direction of the slope of the land, but the streams flow in more or less the same direction. So, it's unlike the radial that had multiple directions of flow from the highest point.

Now, this pattern is very different from either the dendritic or the radial.



This is called a rectangular pattern, and I think you can see why. Just look at all of those right angle turns. The rectangle pattern is typical of a landscape that's been formed by fractured joints and faults. And, because this broken rock is eroded more easily than unbroken rock, stream beds are carved along the jointed bedrock.



Finally, we have the trellis pattern. And here in this example, you can see quite clearly how the tributaries of an almost parallel structure drain into valleys and form the appearance of a garden trellis. This pattern forms in areas where there are alternating bands of variable resistance. And by that, I mean that the bands of rock that are very strong and resistant to erosion alternate with bands of rock that are weak and easily eroded. This often happens when a horizontal plane folds and outcroppings appear.

So, as I said, as a whole, these patterns are dictated by the structure and relief of the land. The kinds of rocks on which the streams are developed, the structural pattern of the folds, faults, and uplift will usually determine a drainage system. However, I should also mention that drainage patterns can occasionally appear to be, well, out of sync with the landscape. And this can happen when a stream flows over older structures that have been uncovered by erosion or when a stream keeps its original drainage system when rocks are uplifted. So, when that happens, the pattern appears to be contrary to the expected course of the stream. But I'm interested in your understanding of the basic drainage system, so I don't plan to trick you with test questions about exceptional patterns. But I expect you to know that exceptions to the patterns can occur when geological events influence them.

Question 6

Listen again to part of the lecture and then answer the following question.

“Okay, today we’re going to discuss the four major types of drainage patterns. Now, I trust you’ve already read the chapter, so you’ll recall that a drainage pattern is the arrangement of channels that carry water in an area.”

Why does the professor say this?

“I trust you’ve already read the chapter, so you’ll recall that a drainage pattern is the arrangement of channels that carry water in an area.”

Listening 2 “Philosophy Class”

Listen to part of a lecture in a Philosophy Class.

Professor:

Humanism is a philosophical position that places the dignity of the individual at the center of its movement. A primary principle of humanism, I don't need to spell that for you, do I? Okay, a primary principle of humanism is that human beings are rational and have an innate predisposition for good. Although humanism is associated with the beginning of the Reformation, the humanist philosophy was not new when it became popular in Italy during the Middle Ages. In fact, according to the ancient Greek philosopher Protagoras, mankind was the measure of all things. And this idea was echoed by Sophocles when he said, Many are the wonders of the world, and none so wonderful as mankind. This is classical humanism. Man as the ideal at the center of all creation. Even the ancient Greek gods were viewed as resembling man both physically and psychologically. And in a sense, isn't this personification of the deity just another way to exalt human beings? But that aside, it was precisely the rediscovery and translation of classical manuscripts that coincided with the invention of printing presses around the mid-15th century, which provided a catalyst for the humanistic movement throughout Europe. As the clergy and upper classes participated in the rediscovery and dissemination of classical literature, humanism became popular among theologians and scholars, and soon set the stage for the Renaissance. This one I'll spell. Does anybody remember the meaning of the word *Renaissance*?

Student 1: Rebirth. Renewal.

Professor:

Right you are. Renaissance literally means rebirth. And it refers to the return to ancient Greek and Roman art and literature, which, like all things in the humanistic tradition, they were measured by human standards. Art returned to the classical principles of harmony and balance. In the field of architecture, we see both religious and secular buildings, styled after ancient Roman designs, with mathematical proportions and a human scale, a scale that contrasted with the medieval Gothic buildings of the previous era. Public works, such as bridges and aqueducts from the Roman occupation, were repaired, restored, or rebuilt. In the sculptures of the period, nude figures were modeled in life-sized images, with true proportions, and it was also at this point that realism became the standard for painting, with a preference for naturalistic settings and the placement of figures in realistic proportion to those settings. It was also evident that the portraits tended to be more personal and authentic, and artists even produced self-portraits at this time. Remember, the figures in the paintings of the previous era tended to be of another world, but Renaissance painters placed recognizable human beings in this world. In music, there was an effort to create harmonies that were pleasing to the human ear, and melodies that were compatible with the human voice. In addition, music lessons became more widespread as a source of education and enjoyment. Dancing increased in popularity, with a concurrent trend toward music that had rhythm and invited movement as a pleasurable activity.

Student 2: Wasn't that why Latin became so important?.

Professor:

Yes. Both Greek and Latin became important as tools for scholarship, and Classical Latin became the basis for an international language of the intellectuals throughout Europe. To be true to humanism and all it represented, it was necessary to be knowledgeable about and faithful to the ancient philosophies as expressed in their writing, and how best to express them than in the original languages. By the way, Latin as a universal language for clerics and the aristocracy, this encouraged the exchange of ideas on a wider scale

than ever before, and legitimized, in a sense, the presumption that mankind was at the center of all things. It also made it possible for individual scholars to make a name for themselves and establish their place in the history of mankind.

Well, it was at this time that a close association, almost a partnership, was forged between art and science. In their efforts to be precise, sculptors and painters studied the human form. In effect, they became anatomists. You may recall the drawing in your textbook, the one by Leonardo da Vinci, which demonstrates the geometrical proportions of the human body. And, of course, Alberti, in his many books on architecture, sculpture and painting, he emphasized the study of mathematics as the underlying principle of all the arts. Whereas artists had considered themselves craftsmen in the Middle Ages, the great Renaissance artists viewed themselves as intellectuals, philosophers, if you will, of humanism. They were designing a world for human beings to live in and enjoy, one that was in proportion and in harmony with mankind. So, perhaps you can see why the so-called Renaissance man emerged.

Student 1: Okay, but exactly what is the definition of a Renaissance man? I know it means a very talented person, but...

Professor:

Good question. Sometimes we use these terms without really defining them. So, I would say that a Renaissance man would be talented, as you said, but would also have to demonstrate broad interests in both the arts and the sciences. The quality that was most admired in the Renaissance was the extraordinary, maybe even universality, of talents in diverse fields of endeavor. After all, this quality proved that mankind was capable of reason and creation, that humanism was justified in placing man in the center of the world, as the measure of all things in it. With the humanistic philosophy as a justification, scholars would interpret the ancient classics, and some of them would argue to a reasonable conclusion a very new and more secular society built on individual human effort. It was not difficult for the Renaissance man to make the leap of logic from classical humanism to political humanism, which encouraged freedom of thought, and indeed, even democracy within both the church and the state. But that is a topic for another day.

Listening 3 “Art Class”

Listen to part of a lecture in an art class. The professor is discussing drawing.

Professor:

Drawing is a very basic art form. It's appealing because it can be used to make a very quick record of the ideas that an artist may be envisioning. So, a drawing can serve as a visual aid for the artist to remember a certain moment of inspiration, and maybe use it for a more detailed work later on. Okay, usually such sketches allow the artist to visualize the proportions and the shapes without much attention to details. So these images can be used by painters, architects, sculptors, any artist, really, and large renderings, sketches of parts of the whole. These can be helpful in the creative process when a huge image might be more difficult to conceive of in its entirety. Or, a sketch of just one face in a crowd can allow the artist to focus on creating just that part of the image. So in many artist studios, countless drawings are strewn about as the final painting or sculpture takes form. And this gives us insight into the creative process, as well as the opportunity to see changes from the images at the beginning in the images of the finished work. It's rare, in fact, for an artist to use permanent materials to begin a piece of art. And some painters, for example, even sketch onto the surface of the canvas before applying the pigments. Now, architects are especially prone to sketches, because, of course, their buildings are so large that an image in smaller scale is necessary to the imagination and implementation of such projects. So these studies become the basis for future works. And again, this is very interesting as a record of the creative process. Okay so far?

Okay. Drawing has several other functions, besides as a temporary reference. For centuries, artists have used drawing as a traditional method of education. By copying the great works, especially of the old masters, aspiring artists could learn a lot about proportion, how to capture light and shadow, and so forth. In fact, some artists who later achieve recognition still continue to use this practice to hone their skills, or simply to pay homage to another artist, as is often the case when a work of art originally created in another medium, like a sculpture, when it's recreated in the form of a drawing. Many examples of drawings of Michelangelo's sculptures were recreated by well-known artists. One that comes to mind is the Study of Michelangelo's Bound Slave by Edgar Degas. The original, by Michelangelo, was a marble sculpture that was, oh, about seven feet in height, but the small drawing was made in a sketch pad. In any case, the study is also considered a masterpiece, on a small scale, of course.

So, what additional purposes might be served by the medium of drawing? Well, let's remember that photography is a relatively new art form. So, prior to the use of photographs to record historical events, a quick drawing by an artist was about the only way to preserve a real-time visual account of an important moment. Although a more permanent visual impression might be rendered later, it would be based on memory, and not on the artist's actual observation. Probably the most often cited example of a sketch that preserved an historical record would be the small drawing of Marie Antoinette as she was taken to the guillotine in a cart through the streets of Paris. Jacques-Louis David sketched this famous drawing on a piece of paper about the size of the palm of his hand. And the artist, the artist as a reporter, is still important, even in modern times, when photography isn't possible. For example, when judges won't permit cameras in the courtroom.

Okay, to review. We've talked about three functions for drawing. As a visual aid for the artist to complete a future work, as a method of education for aspiring artists, or even practiced artists, and a way to report an event. But the sketchbook has other possibilities. Sometimes a drawing is the final execution of the art. Picasso produced hundreds of drawings in, well, every conceivable medium, but especially in pencil and crayon. I find it very interesting that Picasso did so much of this kind of work, drawing, I mean, in his last years. Some critics have argued that he was just laughing at the art world, which was willing to pay

outrageous sums for anything with his name on it. And clearly, a drawing can be executed in a short period of time. But others, other critics, they feel as I do, that Picasso was drawing because it was so basic, and because it was so spontaneous, and so much fun. And also, think about how difficult it really is to produce a quick drawing with a few lines, and no opportunity to recreate the original, either by painting it out, or remodeling the clay, or changing the building materials, or any of the other methods for revision of a finished artistic work that artists have at their disposal. So what I'm saying is that drawing, when it's elevated to a finished piece, it must be done with confidence, and it must show a high degree of creativity and mastery of the art form. In a way, it harkens back to the beginnings of art itself, when some unknown artist must have stuck a finger in the earth to draw an image, or maybe he picked up a stone and made a drawing on the wall of a cave.

Okay, so as a first assignment, I want you to make a couple of sketches yourself. I'm not going to grade them. This isn't a studio art class. I just want you to use a few basic strokes to capture an image. You can do the first one in pencil, crayon, ink, chalk, or even charcoal, whatever you like. Then I want you to sketch the same image in a different medium. So if you do a face in pencil, I want you to do the same face, but in chalk or crayon. Bring them to class next week, and we'll continue our discussion of drawing. But we'll talk more about the materials artists use to produce drawings, and we'll refer to your sketches as examples.

Listening 4 “Bookstore”

Listen to part of a conversation in the bookstore.

Student: Excuse me, I'm looking for someone who can help me with the textbook reservation program.

Manager: Oh, well I can do that. What do you need?

Student: Okay, um, my friend told me that I could get used books if I order, I mean, pre-order them now.

Manager: That's right. You want to do that?

Student: I think so, but I'm not sure how it works.

Manager: Actually, it's fairly straightforward. We have a short form for you to fill out. Do you know what you're going to take next semester?

Student: Yeah, I do.

Manager: And you have the course names and the schedule numbers for all your classes?

Student: Uh-huh.

Manager: Okay then, just put that information down on the form and make a check mark in the box if you want recommended books as well as required books. And you said you were interested in used books, right?

Student: Right.

Manager: So, mark the box for used books, sign the form, and bring it back to me.

Student: Um, do I have to pay now or do you want to deposit?

Manager: No, you can pay when you pick up the books.

Student: And when can I do that?

Manager: The week before classes begin.

Student: That's good, but, um, what if I change my schedule? I mean, I don't plan to, but...

Manager:it happens. Don't worry, if you change classes, you can just bring the books back anytime two weeks from the first day of class to get a full refund. Of course, you'll need the original cash register receipt and a photo ID. And if it's a new book, you can't have any marks in it. But you said you wanted used books, so it won't matter.

Student: Yeah, that's the main reason why I want to do this, because I'll have a better chance to get used books.

Manager: If there are used books available and you mark the form, that's what we'll pull for you.

Student: Okay, thanks a lot. I'll just fill this out and bring it back to you later today. I don't have all the numbers with me, the section numbers for the classes.

Manager: Fine. We need those numbers because when different professors are teaching the same class, they don't always order the same books.

Student: Right. So, will you be here this afternoon?

Manager: I probably will, but if I'm not, just give the form to the person in this office. Don't give it to one of the student employees, though. They're usually very good about getting the forms back to the office, but sometimes it gets really busy, and you know how it is.

Student: Sure. Well, I'll bring it back to the office myself.

Manager: That's probably a good idea. And, oh, one more thing. I should tell you that the used books tend to go first, so if you want to be sure that you get used books...

Student: You know what? I'm going to go right back to the dorm to get those numbers now, while you're still here.

Manager: Okay, that's good.

Question 21

Listen again to part of the conversation, and then answer the following question.

“Don't give it to one of the student employees, though. They're usually very good about getting the forms back to the office, but sometimes it gets really busy, and you know how it is.”

What does the woman mean when she says this?

“Sometimes it gets really busy, and you know how it is.”

Listening 5 “Professor’s Office”

Listen to a conversation on campus between a student and a professor.

Student: Thanks for seeing me, Professor Williams.

Professor: Glad to, Alice. What do you have on your mind?

Student: Well, I got a little mixed up when I started to go over my notes from the last class, so I had a few questions.

Professor: Shoot.

Student: Okay. I understand the three basic sources of personnel for multinational companies. That's fairly self-explanatory.

Professor: Host country, home country, and third country.

Student: Right. But then you started talking about staffing patterns that... Let me see. Okay. You said staffing patterns may vary depending on the length of time that the multinational company has been operating. And you gave some examples, but I got confused, and now I can't read my notes.

Professor: Okay. Well, one pattern is to rely on home country managers to staff the key positions when the company opens, but gradually moving more host country nationals into upper management as the company grows.

Student: So, for example, if a French company opened a factory in Canada, then French management would gradually replace themselves with Canadian managers? Is that what you mean?

Professor: Right. I think I used that very example in class. So do you want to try to explain the second pattern to me?

Student: Sure. I think it's the one where home country nationals are put in charge of the company if it's located in a developed country, but in a developing country, then home country nationals manage the company sort of indefinitely.

Professor: Right again. And an example of that would be...

Student:maybe using German management for a Swiss company in Germany, but they might send Swiss management to provide leadership for a Swiss company in...

Professor: How about Zimbabwe?

Student: This is one of the confusing parts. Zimbabwe has a very old and highly developed culture, so...

Professor:but it's still defined as a developing country because of the economic base, which is being developed now.

Student: Ah, okay. I guess that makes sense. Then the example of the American company with British management, when the company's in India, that would be a third country pattern?

Professor: Yes. In fact, this pattern's fairly prevalent among multinational companies in the United States. Many Scottish or English managers have been hired for top management positions at United States subsidiaries in the former British colonies. India, Jamaica, the West Indies, some parts of Africa...

Student: Okay. So I've got all the examples right now.

Professor: Anything else?

Student: Just one thing. There were some typical patterns for certain countries.

Professor: Like the last example?

Student: No. This came later in the lecture. Something about Japan and Europe?

Professor: Oh, right. I probably said that both Japanese multinational companies and European companies tend to assign senior-level home country managers to overseas locations for their entire careers, whereas multinational companies in the United States view overseas assignments as temporary, so they may actually find themselves reporting to a senior-level manager from the host country who has more experience.

Student: So, for example, a Japanese company in the United States would most probably have senior-level Japanese managers with mid-level managers maybe from the United States, but in Japan, the senior-level Japanese managers at an American company would probably have mid-level American managers reporting to them?

Professor: Well, generalities are always a little tricky, but for the most part, that would be a typical scenario, because living as a permanent expatriate is a career move in Japan, but a temporary strategy in the United States.

Student: Okay. That's interesting.

Professor: And important for you to know as a business major with an interest in international business. You're still on that track, aren't you?

Student: I sure am. But, you know, I wasn't thinking in terms of living abroad for my entire career. That really is a huge commitment, and something to ask about going in. Anyway, like you say, most American companies view overseas assignments as temporary. That's more what I have in mind for myself, I mean.